eventually found a home in the British Museum as the misnamed Amaravati Marbles.

By 1816 Mackenzie had been set right not only about Amaravati but also about the Jains, having been forced to rethink his views by his surveyor colleague Dr Buchanan, who in 1807 had published an account of his travels under the title of *A Journey from Madras through the countries of Mysore, Canara, and Malabar*.[4]

While on the way back to Madras from Mangalore on the last stage of his survey Dr Buchanan had halted at the town of Moodabidri, which turned out to be a major Jain settlement, adorned with some eighteen Jain temples, popularly known as *bastis.* The inhabitants had explained to Buchanan that the entire country thereabouts had at one time been ruled by the Jain rajas of Tuluva but that they were now having to suffer the 'ill-will' of the Brahmins, who regarded them as 'detestable heretics'.

A Jain elder in Moodabidri by the name of Pandit Acharya Swami had then provided Buchanan with what became the first published account of Jainism – even though Buchanan remained under the impression that it was simply a sect within Hinduism. 'The proper name of the sect is *Arhita* (worthy) [more correctly, *arihant*, 'conqueror'],' Buchanan wrote.

> They acknowledge that they are one of the twenty-one sects who were considered by Shankara Acharya as heretical … The *Vedas*, and the eighteen *Puranas* of the Brahmins, the *Arhita* reject as heretical … The gods of the *Arhita* are the spirits of perfect men who, owing to their great virtue, have become exempt from all change and misfortune, and are all of equal rank and power. These *Siddha* (the holy) reside in a heaven called Mocsha, and it is by their worship only that happiness is attained.